August 31, 2026

Dear Dr. Nicolas Lecomte:

Please consider our revised manuscript 'TIM: Tree Imaging Machine for high resolution rapid digital images of tree cores and cookies' as a Practical Tools article for *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*.

Methods to rapidly digitize samples of tree wood are increasingly needed across many fields of ecology, plant biology and climatology. Addressing this need requires a tool that can scan multiple common types of wood samples (e.g., cross-sections) at high resolutions in a rapid and efficient method. The Tree Imaging Machine (TIM) is an open-source robotic tool to address these needs; TIM acquires scans of both increment cores and cookies at high-resolution (at least 21,000 DPI) with accompanied software to prepare a final stitched mosaic.

We were excited to see that the reviewers appreciated our new open-source tool for producing high-quality images, noting how we had combined batch production of high-resolution images in a low-cost design, while also pointing out where we could better show the tool's capabilities and be clearer. Their comments have greatly improved this manuscript and led us to display the capabilities of the tool, revise our figures and refine the language throughout the text. Both reviewers suggested that we include representative full-resolution images, include more details about the implementation, and disclose how much use it has had. We have added multiple scans of cores and cookies from different species in the supplementary material, described TIM's use in the lab for over a year on over 1,000 cores/cookies, and addressed the other comments, as explained in the following pages.

We have attempted to address all the reviewer concerns and detail our changes in our point-by-point response (note that reviewer comments are in *italics*, while our responses are in regular text). The manuscript is 4,648 words with 7 figures. We feel the new submission is much improved. This Practical Tools article is not under examination for publication elsewhere. We hope that you will find it suitable for *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*, and look forward to hearing from you.

Sincerely,

Adam Fong